

CLAT GK - Test 03

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India's Trade Agreements in Early 2026

India and the European Union concluded negotiations on a comprehensive free trade agreement on 27 January 2026, announced at a summit in New Delhi attended by European Council President Antonio Costa and European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen. Von der Leyen described the deal as creating a free trade zone of two billion people. India would remove or reduce tariffs on more than 90 per cent of goods exported from the EU, and European exporters are expected to save about 4 billion euros in duties each year. The agreement has been concluded but not yet signed, and it is not yet in force. Duty reductions are to be phased in over several years.

On 6 February 2026 in Washington, which was 7 February in India, the two governments announced a framework for an interim trade agreement. Under the framework, the United States will lower its applied tariff on Indian exports from 50 per cent to 18 per cent. Half of the earlier 50 per cent was a penalty linked to Russian oil purchases, and the other half was the reciprocal rate. An executive order removed the further 25 per cent duty, which had been imposed on 6 August 2025 over India's purchases of Russian oil, with effect from 7 February 2026. An order directs the Commerce Secretary to monitor Indian imports of Russian oil and to recommend reinstating the duty if such imports resume.

India has committed to eliminate or reduce tariffs on US industrial goods and a range of American food and agricultural products. It intends to buy about 500 billion dollars' worth of US goods over five years, covering energy products, aircraft and aircraft parts, precious metals and technology products. Dairy and genetically modified crops remain excluded from India's tariff concessions. Both governments said further negotiations were needed to complete a broader bilateral trade agreement, so the framework is an interim step rather than a finished deal.

On 24 February 2026, India and the Gulf Cooperation Council signed a joint statement in New Delhi formally launching negotiations on a comprehensive and mutually beneficial free trade agreement. The terms of reference for the talks had been signed on 5 February 2026. Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal and GCC Secretary-General Jasem Albudaiwi signed the joint statement. The GCC comprises six member states: Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates. The bloc is India's largest trading partner group, with bilateral trade of about 178.56 billion dollars in fiscal year 2024-25, including Indian exports of about 56.87 billion dollars and imports of about 121.68 billion dollars. The talks will cover trade in goods, customs procedures, trade in services and digital trade, with the stated aim of removing tariff and non-tariff barriers.

Q1. Where is the headquarters of the Gulf Cooperation Council located?

- (A) Abu Dhabi
- (B) Muscat
- (C) Riyadh
- (D) Doha

Q2. Under which section of the Customs Tariff Act, 1975 may the Central Government impose anti-dumping duty on articles imported below their normal value?

- (A) Section 3
- (B) Section 9A
- (C) Section 12
- (D) Section 11

Q3. Assertion (A): Article 301 of the Constitution of India guarantees freedom of trade, commerce and intercourse throughout the territory of India.

Reason (R): Article 301 was borrowed from the commerce clause of the Constitution of the United States.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q4. Statement I. Article 253 empowers Parliament to make laws for implementing treaties and agreements with foreign countries.

Statement II. Article 253 empowers only the State legislatures to make laws for implementing international treaties.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q5. Statement 1. Agriculture is a subject in the State List of the Seventh Schedule.

Statement 2. Police is a subject in the Union List of the Seventh Schedule.

Statement 3. Public health and sanitation is a subject in the Union List of the Seventh Schedule.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q6. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 112	A. Body constituted to advise on the division of the net proceeds of taxes between the Union and the States
II. Article 265	B. No tax may be levied or collected except by authority of law
III. Article 266	C. Statement of estimated receipts and expenditure of the Government of India laid before Parliament each year
IV. Article 280	D. Government revenues and loans pooled into one fund, from which money may be appropriated only in accordance with law

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

South Korean President's State Visit and Austrian Chancellor's Visit, April 2026

South Korean President Lee Jae Myung made a three-day state visit to India from April 19 to 21, 2026. It was his first visit to India since he took office in June 2025. On arrival in New Delhi, he was received at the airport by Minister of State Harsh Malhotra, and External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar called on him.

On April 20, Lee received a ceremonial welcome at Rashtrapati Bhavan from President Droupadi Murmu. He then held talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi at Hyderabad House in New Delhi. Their discussions produced a Joint Strategic Vision for the India-Republic of Korea Special Strategic Partnership. The leaders also adopted a framework for partnership in shipbuilding, shipping and maritime logistics, and issued a joint statement on energy resource security. The energy statement focused on stable energy supply chains and cooperation on energy resource trade and investment. During the visit, South Korea also joined the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative and the International Solar Alliance.

The same day, business leaders from both countries held an India-Korea Business Forum in New Delhi, where memorandums of understanding were signed in steel, shipbuilding, digital services and energy. JSW Steel and the POSCO Group also agreed to form a 50:50 joint venture to build a greenfield integrated steel plant with a capacity of 6 million tonnes per annum in Odisha. The venture will be formed through Saffron Resources Private Limited, a JSW Steel subsidiary, which will become an equal partnership between the two companies. POSCO will acquire its stake for Rs 508.8 crore, subject to closing adjustments. Saffron Resources holds about 887 acres of land in Odisha.

Earlier in April, Austrian Chancellor Christian Stocker made an official visit to India in April 2026. It was his first visit to the country. On April 16, he held bilateral talks with Prime Minister Modi at Hyderabad House, New Delhi, followed by the signing of agreements and joint press statements. The documents signed included a joint letter of intent on dual vocational training, skills development and the recognition of vocational qualifications. A separate letter of intent was signed between India's Ministry of Defence

and the Austrian defence ministry on military cooperation. The package also covered an audiovisual co-production agreement for films, and a memorandum between India's Food Safety and Standards Authority and Austria's Agency for Health and Food Safety, known as AGES, on food safety cooperation.

Q7. Which Article of the Constitution of India empowers Parliament to make laws for giving effect to international treaties, agreements and decisions taken at international conferences?

- (A) Article 262
- (B) Article 253
- (C) Article 256
- (D) Article 245

Q8. In which year did the India-South Korea Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) come into force?

- (A) 2010
- (B) 2007
- (C) 2012
- (D) 2009

Q9. Hyderabad House in New Delhi, the venue of the India-South Korea talks, was originally built as a residence for which ruler?

- (A) Maharaja of Mysore
- (B) Nizam of Hyderabad
- (C) Nawab of Rampur
- (D) Nawab of Bhopal

Q10. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative	A. Headquartered in Beijing
II. International Solar Alliance	B. Launched at COP21 in Paris
III. Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank	C. Launched on the sidelines of the G20 summit in New Delhi
IV. Global Biofuels Alliance	D. Unveiled at the East Asia Summit in Bangkok

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q11. Assertion (A): The International Atomic Energy Agency is headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.

Reason (R): The IAEA's headquarters were established in Vienna, Austria, in 1957 at the invitation of the Austrian government.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q12. Statement I. Austria is a member of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO).

Statement II. Austria joined the European Union in 1995.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

IPL 2026 Final and Season Awards

Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) retained the Indian Premier League (IPL) title after beating Gujarat Titans (GT) by five wickets in the IPL 2026 final at the Narendra Modi Stadium in Ahmedabad. It was RCB's second straight final, and they became only the third franchise to win back-to-back titles, after Chennai Super Kings and Mumbai Indians. They had won their first trophy in 2025.

The season had opened on 28 March at the M. Chinnaswamy Stadium in Bengaluru, where RCB hosted Sunrisers Hyderabad (SRH).

Batting first in the final, GT scored 155 for eight in their 20 overs. RCB reached 161 for five in reply, with 12 balls to spare.

The two finalists had already met in Qualifier 1 at Dharamshala on Tuesday, 26 May. RCB made 254 for five and won by 92 runs. Rajat Patidar, the RCB captain, was unbeaten on 93 off 33 balls.

Four teams reached the playoffs from the league stage. RCB, GT and SRH each finished on 18 points, with RCB top on net run rate. Rajasthan Royals (RR) took the last spot with 16 points. RR had sealed their place on 24 May with a 30-run win over Mumbai Indians (MI) at the Wankhede Stadium, their final league match. RR scored 205 for eight after recovering from 119 for five, and MI were held to 175 for nine. Punjab Kings and Kolkata Knight Riders were eliminated.

In the Eliminator on 27 May, RR beat SRH by 47 runs. Rajasthan made 243 for eight in 20 overs, with Rajasthan opener Vaibhav Sooryavanshi scoring 97 off 29 balls, including 12 sixes. SRH were bowled out for 196 in 19.2 overs, and their season ended there.

Qualifier 2 was played at Mullanpur on Friday, 29 May. Rajasthan made 214 for six, and GT reached 219 for three in 18.4 overs to win by seven wickets. Shubman Gill scored 104 off 53 balls, and the win sent GT into the final against RCB.

Sooryavanshi, aged 15, won the Orange Cap with 776 runs in 16 matches, becoming the youngest winner of the award. Gill finished second on the run charts, and Sai Sudharsan of Gujarat Titans third. Sooryavanshi also broke Chris Gayle's record for the most sixes in a season, surpassing the 59 Gayle hit in 2012. He was named the Most Valuable Player and the Emerging Player of the Season, and also won the Super Striker and Super Sixes awards.

Sai Sudharsan hit the most fours of the season, while Mohammed Siraj bowled the most dot balls of any bowler. Manish Pandey of Kolkata Knight Riders won the Catch of the Season award.

Q13. Which franchise did Kagiso Rabada play for when he won the IPL Purple Cap in 2020?

- (A) Rajasthan Royals
- (B) Gujarat Titans
- (C) Delhi Capitals
- (D) Sunrisers Hyderabad

Q14. Who won the IPL Purple Cap for the 2021 season?

- (A) Yuzvendra Chahal
- (B) Harshal Patel
- (C) Mohammed Shami
- (D) Imran Tahir

Q15. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Sohail Tanvir (2008 Purple Cap)	A. Sunrisers Hyderabad
II. RP Singh (2009 Purple Cap)	B. Rajasthan Royals
III. Bhuvneshwar Kumar (2017 Purple Cap)	C. Deccan Chargers
IV. Imran Tahir (2019 Purple Cap)	D. Chennai Super Kings

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q16. Assertion (A): Virat Kohli was named Player of the Match in the IPL 2026 final.

Reason (R): Mohammed Shami won the IPL Purple Cap in 2024.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q17. Statement I. Dwayne Bravo won the IPL Purple Cap in 2016.

Statement II. Kagiso Rabada won the IPL Purple Cap in 2025.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q18. Statement I. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi comes from Bihar.

Statement II. Lasith Malinga won the IPL Purple Cap in 2011 while playing for Mumbai Indians.

Statement III. Morne Morkel won the IPL Purple Cap in 2012 while playing for Chennai Super Kings.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) All of the above

Cabinet Clears Samudra Manthan, Khelo India Revamp and PM-KISAN Extension

The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved three major decisions on Friday, 31 July 2026. Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw briefed reporters on them. Among these was the National Offshore Exploration Scheme, named Samudra Manthan, with an outlay of ₹84,084 crore running up to FY 2030-31. It is a central sector scheme of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

The scheme covers the full offshore exploration chain. Its components include seismic surveys, deepwater drilling, scientific drilling in frontier basins, shared offshore production and evacuation infrastructure, and an integrated Oil and Gas Manufacturing and Services Zone. About ₹28,534 crore has been earmarked for offshore seismic data acquisition and processing, and ₹10,000 crore for common offshore production and evacuation infrastructure. The scheme also supports 60 deepwater exploration wells, with government assistance of up to 50 per cent of the eligible drilling cost of each well. Its interventions include large-scale acquisition, processing and interpretation of high-quality seismic data, and accelerated deepwater and ultra-deepwater exploratory drilling.

The government said the scheme is expected to catalyse reserve accretion of over 600 million metric tonnes of oil equivalent (MMTOE). That figure is a projection, not a confirmed discovery. The government presented the scheme as a step towards energy security, and reports linked the approval to global energy supply concerns driven by geopolitical conflicts.

Drilling had already started before the approval. ONGC spudded its first deepwater exploratory well, MN-DW18-1-H-D, in the Mahanadi offshore basin on 25 July 2026 under the Samudra Manthan mission, six days before the Cabinet cleared the scheme.

The Cabinet also approved an expanded Khelo India Scheme and enhanced assistance to National Sports Federations, with a combined outlay of ₹36,441 crore for 2026-27 to 2030-31. The government described this outlay as nearly eight times that of the previous Khelo India scheme. The revamp creates a network of National Centres of Excellence, Khelo India Centres of Excellence, SAI Training Centres, Khelo India Accredited Academies, Khelo India Centres and Youth Sports Companies of the Armed Forces. The package is meant to cover talent identification, scientific training, competition exposure and Olympic preparation.

Two new school-level initiatives, Khelo India Feeder Schools and Khelo India Utkrishta Vidyalayas, will link sport with mainstream education. An Emerging Khelo India Athletes category is meant to widen the athlete pipeline. Vaishnaw said every talented youth should get a clear pathway to excellence, and that the scheme would build training facilities from the grassroots level up to the Target Olympic Podium Scheme (TOPS).

The same meeting also approved the continuation of PM-KISAN for five financial years, 2026-27 to 2030-31, with an outlay of ₹3,15,614 crore. Vaishnaw announced the decision, which keeps the income-support scheme for farmers running through the period. The Samudra Manthan and Khelo India decisions were taken at the same meeting.

Q19. ONGC began drilling its first deepwater exploratory well under the Samudra Manthan mission in the Mahanadi offshore basin in July 2026. On which Indian state's coast does the Mahanadi basin lie?

- (A) Tamil Nadu
- (B) Odisha
- (C) Andhra Pradesh
- (D) Gujarat

Q20. The National Sports Policy 2025 (Khelo Bharat Niti) aims to make India one of the top five sporting nations by which year?

- (A) 2047
- (B) 2050
- (C) 2036
- (D) 2040

Q21. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. PM-KISAN	A. 2014
II. Target Olympic Podium Scheme	B. 2016-17
III. Khelo India Scheme	C. 2019
IV. National Sports Policy 2025	D. 2025

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q22. Assertion (A): ONGC began drilling its first deepwater exploratory well in the Mahanadi offshore basin in July 2026.

Reason (R): Article 282 of the Constitution allows the Union or a State to make grants for any public purpose, even outside its legislative subjects.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q23. Statement I. The Krishna-Godavari basin lies off the coast of Tamil Nadu.

Statement II. The Cauvery basin lies off the coast of West Bengal.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q24. Statement 1. The 2030 Commonwealth Games will be hosted by Ahmedabad.

Statement 2. PM-KISAN pays Rs 12,000 per year to eligible farmer families.

Statement 3. The Target Olympic Podium Scheme was launched by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.

Statement 4. The National Sports Policy 2025 was approved by the Union Cabinet in 2023.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Former Army chief dies; new minority panel chair and CBDT chief named

Gen Vishwa Nath Sharma (retd), a former Chief of the Army Staff, died on Friday, 31 July 2026, the Indian Army said. He was the younger brother of Major Somnath Sharma, India's first Param Vir Chakra awardee. He led the Army from 1988 to 1990. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh expressed grief over the demise of the former Chief of the Army Staff. His last rites were performed with full military honours at Brar Square in Delhi Cantonment on Saturday, 1 August 2026.

The Centre has nominated Harjit Singh Grewal as Chairperson of the National Commission for Minorities. A Ministry of Minority Affairs notification dated 16 July 2026 also named S. Munawari Begum as Vice-Chairperson and Glenn E. Souza Ticlo as Member. The three will serve for three years from the date they assume office, or until further orders, whichever is earlier. Grewal assumed charge in New Delhi on 21 July 2026, days after the order.

On 30 June 2026, the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet approved the reappointment of Ravi Agrawal as Chairman of the Central Board of Direct Taxes on a contract basis. Agrawal, a 1988-batch Indian Revenue Service officer, was due to retire on 30 June. The six-month extension took effect on 1 July 2026 and runs until December 2026. A senior finance ministry official said the move was aimed at ensuring continuity in direct tax policy formulation and enabling certain special initiatives.

On 22 July 2026, the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet named Anurag Jain, a 1989-batch IAS officer of the Madhya Pradesh cadre, as Chief Executive Officer of NITI Aayog. His tenure is two years or until further orders, whichever is earlier. Jain had been Chief Secretary of Madhya Pradesh. Ashok Barnwal, a 1991-batch IAS officer of the same cadre, took over as the state's Chief Secretary in late July 2026.

On 1 July 2026, the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet approved a one-year extension for Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri, a 1989-batch Indian Foreign Service officer. His service now runs until 14 July 2027, or until further orders, whichever comes first. The extension came beyond his original tenure, which ended on 14 July 2026. Reports described the decision as a signal of continuity amid global challenges.

Varsha Ashok Aglawe succeeded Asit Saha as Director General of the Geological Survey of India, becoming the first woman to lead the organisation in its 176-year history. Separately, the Ministry of Corporate Affairs made Justice (retd) Yogesh Khanna, a Member (Judicial) of the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal, its officiating Chairperson for three months from 5 July 2026, or until a regular Chairperson is appointed. The notification followed the end of Justice Ashok Bhushan's term on 4 July 2026.

Q25. How many religious communities have been notified as minorities at the Centre's level in India?

- (A) Five
- (B) Four
- (C) Seven
- (D) Six

Q26. Under which Article of the Constitution of India is the supreme command of the Union's armed forces vested in the President?

- (A) Article 74
- (B) Article 77
- (C) Article 52
- (D) Article 53

Q27. Assertion (A): The Central Board of Direct Taxes functions under the Department of Revenue in the Ministry of Finance.

Reason (R): The CBDT was constituted under Article 30 of the Constitution of India.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q28. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Election Commission of India	A. Article 263
II. Inter-State Council	B. Article 280
III. National Commission for Scheduled Castes	C. Article 324
IV. Finance Commission	D. Article 338

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q29. Statement I. A Governor is appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal.

Statement II. A Governor holds office for a term of five years from the date of entering office, subject to the pleasure of the President.

Statement III. A person is eligible for appointment as Governor on completing 30 years of age.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) All of the above

Q30. Statement 1. The Vice-President of India is elected by an electoral college consisting of the members of both Houses of Parliament.

Statement 2. The Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha is elected by the members of the Rajya Sabha from among themselves.

Statement 3. The Speaker of the Lok Sabha is chosen by the members of the Lok Sabha from among themselves.

Statement 4. The members of the Union Public Service Commission are appointed by the Prime Minister.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four